Processing, QA/QC and Deliverables

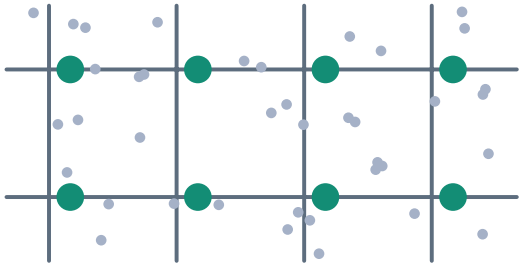
BIG IDEA

Clean the cloud: throw out lonely dots, and keep one dot per box.

the crowd stays

lonely dot:
dust or a bird

boxes too big lose the curb!



each box keeps one dot

THE IDEA

Picture a crowd standing close together in a park, except one person way out by the fence. You can tell that person is alone because their nearest neighbors are far away. Cleaning a point cloud works the same way: dots whose neighbors are far away are usually dust, rain, birds or reflections, so they are thrown out.

REMEMBER

- ✓ Lonely dots are removed (**outlier removal**).
- ✓ Thinning keeps one dot per little box. Boxes that are too big round off curbs and edges.
- ✓ Ground dots are sorted out to build the bare-earth surface.

TRY THIS

Spread a handful of beans on a table and push one far away. Which bean is the “lonely dot”? Now draw a grid and keep just one bean in each square.

The full module is in the Reference Book.